

Task 2- Sample 1

In many countries, smoking is now illegal in public places. Many people believe that such a ban is justified.

Do you agree or disagree?

Smoking has been banned in public places like parks, hospitals and restaurants in many nations, and it is a law that many people support. This essay also agrees with this initiative because it reduces the harmful effects of passive smoking and also encourages smokers to quit.

The primary reason why making it illegal to smoke in public makes sense is that it prevents people from developing diseases related to second-hand smoke. Passive smoking is something that non-smokers cannot avoid in the presence of a smoker, and it is just as dangerous to people's health as smoking. A ban in public places limits this type of exposure. For example, after Ireland decided to ban smoking in all indoor workplaces, there was a significant decline in lung cancer and other lethal diseases among restaurant and pub workers, leading many other countries to adopt similar measures.

The second main reason why this ban is warranted is that it helps those addicted to cigarettes quit their habit. A law prohibiting smoking in public areas would force smokers to leave the company of everyone else if they want to have a cigarette. Most people dislike feeling ostracised, and this would provide excellent motivation to quit. For instance, social pressure brought about by smoking bans is often cited by ex-smokers as one of the reasons they gave up the habit.

In conclusion, this essay believes that making it against the law to smoke in public should be encouraged because it prevents innocent people from developing serious health conditions caused by passive smoking and reduces the number of smokers.

Task 2- Sample 2

Some people think that a sense of competition in children should be encouraged. Others believe that children who are taught to cooperate rather than compete become more useful adults.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion.

It is argued that children should be motivated to be competitive, while others feel that teaching them to be cooperative will be of more value as they enter adulthood. I believe that while competition can help children be successful, cooperation is more important because it teaches them to work within a team, a crucial adult skill.

Some argue that instilling a sense of competition in children helps them to achieve success in whatever they do. This is because being competitive creates a drive to win, which teaches them that hard work and discipline are the keys to success. For example, it is often the case that children who participate in competitive sports are less likely to quit when things are difficult and are, therefore, more likely to overcome obstacles in their jobs as adults. Despite this, I would argue that children require lessons on teamwork more than the will to win.

If children are taught to be cooperative, they learn the importance of working in a team, which is something adults are expected to do. Through working with others, children learn not only how to respect different opinions but also how to pool their strengths. For instance, preschools include cooperation as one of the first skills in their curriculum as they recognise that it is a vital social skill in all spheres of life. I therefore believe that teaching children to work with others is more important than giving them a sense of competition.

In conclusion, while instilling a sense of competition in children can help them succeed, I think that teaching children to be cooperative gives them the ability to work as part of a team, which is far more valuable later in life.

Task 2- Sample 3

Some parents think that childcare centres provide the best services for children of preschool age. Other working parents think that family members such as grandparents are better caregivers for their young children.

Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Some argue that when parents are at work, close relations provide the best care to young children, while others believe daycare centres offer a better option. While relatives can usually be trusted to take care of youngsters properly, this essay argues that childcare professionals are better equipped to care for young children.

Many parents in full-time employment prefer to leave their offspring with grandparents or siblings when they are at work because they trust them more. This is because they feel their child will be safer with someone from within the family. For example, working mothers in South Africa often ask their parents to take care of their children because childcare centres have a high turnover rate, which means there are too many new staff members that the parents do not know very well. However, this essay argues that a family connection does not guarantee that a person can take care of young children well.

Others say that daycare centres are a better option due to the fact that their employees are skilled professionals. Many of those employed in these centres have been rigorously trained in how to nurture children's growth, and they are therefore able to provide a suitable level of care to any child placed under their supervision. For instance, most childcare centres in developed countries require their employees to have completed certificates in early childhood development. For this reason, I believe that the children left in the care of these centres are better looked after.

In conclusion, although some parents may prefer the bond of trust inherent within a family when choosing a caregiver for their children, this essay finds that children are better off under the care of daycare centres due to their staff's professional training and experience.

Task 2- Sample 4

Life was better when technology was simpler.

To what extent do you agree or disagree?

It is argued that our lives **were more fulfilling** when technology **was less complex**. This essay **completely disagrees with this statement** and believes that **computers and the internet have made life much better** because **smartphones save us time** and **the internet has improved education**.

New phones, such as the iPhone, have made our daily lives much less laborious and have given us more free time. Jobs that used to require a lot of energy and time can now be done at the touch of a button. For example, if people wanted to communicate with one another in the past, they had to write a letter, take it to the post office, and then wait for it to be delivered, **whereas** these days people can simply tap the email icon on our touch screen and send a message to whomever they want to communicate with within seconds.

The internet has also **enriched** education. **In the past**, students had to rely on a teacher and physical books for their education, and these were often either unavailable or in a format that most people did not want, but now the internet provides us with more information than we could ever dream of, **and** this has made us **more independent and effective learners**. For example, there are now thousands of free online courses available on YouTube that anyone can watch and learn from anywhere in the world.

In conclusion, this essay argues that life has been greatly improved by technological advancements, particularly labour-saving phones and the learning opportunities provided by the internet.

Task 2- Sample 5

At present, the media affects people's lives significantly.

What impact does this have on society? Is it a negative or positive development?

The media has a significant impact on the way people live their lives. This essay **will discuss** how the media shapes how people think about world events and **suggest that** this is a negative development because it endangers democracy.

A major impact of the media is that it affects how people interpret things happening in the world. Most people take the news at face value and do not think about it very critically. **This leads** to them believing everything they read or hear and **can result in them having a distorted view of key issues**. Take the current refugee crisis **as an example**, where, as a result of how refugees were represented in the UK news, people came to view them as 'migrants' who were looking to overrun the UK and take advantage of its economic prosperity, when in reality, these people were simply fleeing war-torn countries.

This distortion means that governments and corporations can influence the media and get them to spin a narrative that suits their agenda, which is very dangerous for democracy. A healthy democracy must have a free press that is critical of the state and big business, and if it does not, democracy will be in peril. For example, **it is widely known that** certain news networks in the USA regularly tell lies about the Democratic Party and seek to support the Republican Party, which is very disturbing when you consider that tens of millions of people tune in to networks every day.

In conclusion, the media affects our view of the world by telling us what to think, **and this is a negative development** because unless people make up their own minds rather than blindly believing whatever they hear or read, democracy is threatened.

Task 2- Sample 6

There are many reasons that can motivate a person to stay working for the same company. Some believe that money is the main reason.

Do you agree or disagree?

People are motivated to stay in the same job for many reasons, and a number of individuals think that money is the primary reason. This essay disagrees that salary is the main factor because most companies pay a similar amount of money for the same job, and the culture of a company is far more important than monetary considerations.

It does not make sense to say that money is the primary reason why people stay with the same company because for any job there are many companies all offering a similar salary. This can easily be demonstrated by looking in the employment section of any newspaper and looking at similar roles in the same city. For example, a quick search on www.indeed.co.uk would show that, at any given time in London, there are over fifty jobs for human resource managers that all offer a salary of around £80,000 per year.

What is more important is whether people fit in with the ethos of the corporation. Some organisations focus on performance at the expense of free time, and while some employees are not suited to demanding jobs, others thrive in this environment. Other workplaces are very relaxed and emphasise work-life balance, which some workers like. This is illustrated by the fact that some men and women leave high-pressure jobs after they have children primarily because they value being able to spend more time with their families.

In conclusion, this essay disagrees that wages are the most important consideration when remaining in the same job for a long period of time because if employees do not like their current job, they can simply move to another company and get paid more or less the same, and corporate culture is a far more relevant concern.

Task 2- Sample 7

In Britain, when someone gets old, they often go to live in a home with other old people where there are nurses to look after them. Sometimes the government has to pay for this care.

Who do you think should pay for this care, the government or the family?

Give **reasons** for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own knowledge or experience.

In the UK, the elderly are looked after by caregivers in old people's homes, which at times is paid for by the state. This essay believes that the state should pay for this type of assistance because of the contribution that old people have made to their society and because most families could not cope with the financial burden.

When a person gets to the age where they need help looking after themselves, the government should pay for this because that person has given the government tax all their life. If a person only makes minimum wage and pays tax every month for thirty years, this adds up to a large sum of money, which is more than enough to cover the cost of taking care of that person when they are old and infirm. In the UK, for example, everyone has to pay National Insurance and income tax, and part of this should go towards helping the elderly when they are old and need nursing care.

If the government does not pay, then the bill is left with the family, and most people simply cannot afford this on top of their normal expenses. Nursing homes require specialist care and twenty-four-hour attention, which is very expensive for the average person, especially if they have more than one elderly relative to pay for. For instance, the average nursing home bill in the United Kingdom is one third of the average wage.

To conclude, older people or their families should not have to worry about expensive nursing bills after they retire because the contributions they have made when they are working should cover this expense, and their families would not be able to afford the bills without assistance.

Task 2- Sample 8

Modern children are suffering from the diseases that were once considered to only be meant for adults. **Obesity** is a major disease prevalent among children.

What are its causes, and what solutions can be offered?

Being obese was once only a condition that adults suffered from, but it is becoming more common in children. This essay will **first discuss** how **fast food and a sedentary lifestyle** are the primary causes of this growing problem, **followed by a discussion** of **how education and increased exercise** are **the most viable** solutions.

One cause of obesity in children is the increasing popularity of fast-food restaurants. Fast food usually contains an **exorbitant** number of calories because it is very high in fat and sugar. **In addition**, young people are living a more sedentary lifestyle. Nowadays, more children choose computer games or social media over physical activity, so they are unable to burn the extra calories they are eating. It can be commonly seen in many western nations, for instance, that the number of children who participate in after-school sports has dropped significantly over the last decade.

The best solution to this problem of obesity is to educate children about the dangers of being severely overweight. If children are more aware of the types of diseases associated with obesity, they **might think twice** before asking their parents to take them to the local burger restaurant. **Moreover**, schools should introduce more exercise into their curriculums. If children take part in sport, the physical activity will allow them to burn calories and avoid weight gain. Schools where children are required to participate in at least one team sport, for example, typically have lower obesity rates.

In conclusion, many children are struggling with their weight **because of** eating too much junk food combined with a sedentary lifestyle. **However**, if schools give children enough information about the risks they are taking by doing this and require children to take more exercise, **the problem can be alleviated**.

Task 2- Sample 9

In many countries, children are engaged in some kind of paid work. Some people regard this as completely wrong, while others consider it as valuable work experience.

Discuss both views and give your opinion.

In many places, children are involved in various types of employment. Some would say that this is utterly wrong, while others are of the opinion that this is fine because it prepares them for the workforce. This essay agrees with the latter point and will show that, despite some concerns about **its effect on education**, working at a young age can enhance a person's character.

It is often argued that working before the age of eighteen is wrong because it impacts how successful children are in their studies. **This is because** they are under increasing pressure to perform academically, and a job will force them to reduce the time they have to study. For example, a UK children's charity found that children who worked part-time were less likely to achieve higher grades than those who did not. **However, I believe** the lessons children can learn from working are invaluable.

Getting a part-time job contributes towards children's character development. It teaches them the value of hard work and exposes them to the real world, where they learn things they would never learn in the classroom. This can also result in them working harder and being more disciplined at school. For example, a teenager working in a restaurant for a few hours at the weekend can learn how to interact with the general public without their academic performance being negatively affected. **For this reason, I believe that concerns about work's negative effects on education are unfounded.**

In conclusion, **despite** fears that children will neglect their studies if they are required to work, **this essay thinks that** a little work experience at a young age can build character, and actually help students achieve their educational goals.

Task 2- Sample 10

Air transport is increasingly used to export fruit and vegetables to countries where they cannot be grown or are out of season.

What are the advantages and disadvantages of this?

Fresh produce is more frequently being exported by air into countries where it is out of season or impossible to grow. **The advantages of this are that** consumers can enjoy a wider range of fresh fruit and vegetables all year and some countries rely on imported food to feed their people. **However,** this puts tremendous strain on the environment because of pollution produced by airplanes and harmful farming methods.

One benefit of importing fruit and vegetables is the wide range of products that can be found throughout the year. Some countries are only able to produce certain crops during specific seasons, so, without imports, they wouldn't be able to consume these foods year-round. **Moreover,** imported produce is vital for survival in some countries. **This is because** their harsh environment prevents sufficient food from being grown. Qatar, for instance, is mostly desert and relies largely on imported produce.

On the other hand, a lot of pollution is caused by airplanes. Each time food is exported, a huge amount of fuel is burned, **resulting in** carbon emissions that contribute to global warming. **This is compounded by the fact** that exporting food often results in farming practices that damage the environment. The extra demand of overseas markets requires domestic producers to increase their food production, **which often means** using dangerous pesticides and herbicides. In Spain, for example, it is common for farmers to use glyphosate herbicides, and many waterways are contaminated with these hazardous chemicals.

In conclusion, **while** exporting produce overseas allows people to eat a variety of fresh fruit and vegetables throughout the year and is essential for people in some countries to survive, **it is important to** pay attention to the costs to the environment caused by air transport and changes to farming methods.

Task 2- Sample 11

Some people get into debt by buying things they do not need and are unable to afford.

What are the **reasons** for this behaviour?

What **action** can be taken to prevent people from having this problem?

Many people owe money because they purchase unnecessary goods that they cannot afford. Relentless advertising in the media and the easy availability of credit **are the main reasons** for this, and I believe it is the **responsibility of governments to intervene and issue stricter guidelines to prevent irresponsible lending and to regulate advertising in the media.**

Advertising in the media has caused many people to go into debt. Clever marketing can lead people to believe they need something when in reality they do not, driving them to spend unnecessarily. Another reason that people are buying things they cannot afford is the fact that credit is easily available. Nowadays financial institutions make it widely known that anyone can get a credit card or a loan. For example, wonga.com has been heavily criticized in the United Kingdom for providing short-term loans at high interest rates that can be instantly sent to someone's bank account after applying online.

These practices could be curbed through government **regulation of excessive advertising and unsound lending practices.** **In other words,** if governments capped the amount of advertising allowed in the media and required applicants for loans or credit to prove that they have sufficient income, people would be under less pressure to spend recklessly and also would not have the means to do so. For example, in Germany, a person is not allowed to borrow more than 10% of their annual income in any one year, and if they do, the bank will be penalized with a heavy fine.

In conclusion, **rampant lending** and **excessive marketing** have led to many people being burdened with debt, but this can be avoided if authorities regulate advertising and put in place proper rules that lenders must adhere to.

Task 2- Sample 12

People naturally resist making changes in their lives.

What kinds of **problems** can this cause? What **solutions** can you suggest?

It is a fact of life that people do not like change. The main problems this causes are **missed opportunities and stagnation**. The most viable solutions are **using self-help resources to develop a more optimistic attitude** and **taking practical steps to reduce risks**.

People who resist change often miss out on opportunities. When someone stays in a job or relationship they are unhappy with because they fear change, they deny themselves the chance to find a situation which will better fit their dreams and goals. **Additionally**, many people end up stagnating. They tolerate their lives, even though they are not really happy, and find themselves in a rut because they are afraid of the risks that change brings. For instance, countless people who continue to work in unsatisfying jobs do so because they fear the uncertainties that accompany finding a new job.

One way for people to overcome this difficulty is **by reading self-help literature to develop a positive mindset**. These books usually contain practical tips and success stories, both of which encourage people to see that change can be extremely positive. Another solution is for people **to identify practical steps** they can take to reduce the risks associated with change. If people educate themselves about what to expect in new situations, they will be better prepared and there will be less risk of failure. For example, many people have been able to face their fears and apply for a new job by researching what their prospective employer requires and how to succeed in job interviews.

In conclusion, **when people avoid change, it can result in** wasted opportunities and being stuck in a rut. Reading self-help books to become more optimistic and taking practical measures to reduce risks **are two possible solutions**.

Task 2- Sample 13

Many museums charge for admission, while others are free.

Do you think the advantages of charging people for admissions to museums outweigh the disadvantages?

A number of museums charge an entry fee, while others do not. This essay thinks that the **drawbacks of charging fees do not outweigh the benefits** because **although** some people are excluded when museums charge admission, this funding enables many museums to remain open.

The main disadvantage of charging entry to museums is that high fees exclude some of the population, especially in less developed countries. Many people in poorer countries have just enough money for food and shelter, so paying for non-essential items like exhibits and museums is impossible. For example, one of most famous museums in Egypt charges about \$7 USD for admission, which is far too expensive for the large number of Egyptians who earn less than \$2 USD per day. **However, this essay would argue** that without this income museums would struggle to survive.

One benefit of entry fees is that they allow many museums to keep their doors open. Not all museums receive government funding, and even those who do often find it insufficient to cover operating costs. Ticket sales make it possible for them to keep running, which enables at least some people to see the exhibits, rather than none at all. For instance, in the UK, there have been huge government spending cuts over the last few years, and a number of museums have had to rely on entrance fees to stay open. **This essay believes that the most important consideration** is the continuation of museums, despite the costs.

In conclusion, **although it is unfortunate that not everyone can enjoy the exhibits in a museum if an entry fee is charged**, the money earned from admission is often the only thing that is keeping the doors open, making such a fee much more beneficial.

Task 2- Sample 14

As most people spend a major part of their adult life at work, job satisfaction is an important element of individual wellbeing.

What are the **factors** that contribute to job satisfaction?

How realistic is the expectation of job satisfaction for all workers?

As the majority of adults spend most of their time at work, being content with their career is a crucial part of their health and happiness. This essay will first discuss how **being respected** and **well paid** contribute toward job satisfaction and then suggest that **expecting everyone to be happy with their career is unrealistic** because **many people's circumstances force them to work in unfulfilling jobs**.

One factor that leads to people being satisfied with their job is being treated with respect. If employees feel that their managers appreciate them and the work they do, it gives them a sense of ownership and they enjoy their work more because their contributions matter. **A fair salary and benefits are also important considerations.** If workers feel they are being underpaid, they will either resent their bosses or look for another job. In the UK, for example, the most cited reason for leaving a job last year was an inadequate salary.

I do not think it is feasible to expect everyone to enjoy their work because many people have no other choice but to do jobs they do not like. Attaining a rewarding job usually requires a good education, which many people cannot afford. **The result is that** they end up working in unsatisfying roles just to be able to survive. **An example of this is** workers in sweatshops or factories, who cannot quit their terrible jobs because they are unable to secure better employment elsewhere.

In conclusion, being satisfied at work is an important part of a person's wellbeing, and respect from management and fair pay can improve one's level of happiness. However, job satisfaction for all workers is an unrealistic prospect because circumstances make it impossible for everyone to have a rewarding job.

Task 2- Sample 15

A person's worth nowadays seems to be judged according to social status and material possessions. Old fashioned values such as honour, kindness, and trust no longer seem important.

To what extent do you agree or disagree?

It is argued that people are judged these days by how much money they have rather than their morals and character. This essay totally agrees with this statement. This essay will first discuss how people instantly judge others by what clothes they wear or products they own, and then suggest that a lack of traditional values in celebrities demonstrates that being a good person is not held in high regard by society.

People seem to hold someone in high regard if they have designer clothes, a luxury car or the latest smartphone, and rarely look inside that person. This superficial attitude is common in all walks of life, whether it be how a store attendant treats you in a shop, or what someone might think of you when interviewing you for a new job. For instance, at most restaurants, people who wear business suits are treated with more respect and courtesy than those who wear casual clothes.

This is also reflected in our celebrities. Most singers, models and actors have neither talent nor moral fibre, but they are still revered because they have a high position in society and seem to have a luxurious lifestyle. Miley Cyrus is a prime example; she does not write her own songs and openly confesses to taking drugs, yet she is still adored by people all over the world.

In conclusion, being a good person is not as important as wealth, fame and where you are on the social ladder these days, and this can easily be seen by how we treat those with no money and how we look up to vacuous stars.

Task 2- Sample 16

The internet has transformed the way information is shared and consumed, but it has also created problems that did not exist before.

What are **the most serious problems** associated with the internet and what are **the possible solutions**?

The way which information is circulated has been completely transformed by the internet, but this has also created issues we never had before. **The most serious problems** are **identity theft and cyberbullying in schools**, and **the most effective solutions** are **more secure passwords and tighter social media regulations**.

One problem related to the internet is personal information being stolen. This type of information can be illegally obtained by criminals with advanced IT skills who can hack online servers where it is stored. **Another problem is that school bullies** can cause psychological distress on the internet. Cyberbullying has terrible consequences because social media can be used by bullies to victimise other students after school hours as the reach of the internet is not limited to within the school grounds. For example, in Ireland, more children than ever before are being counselled because they feel that they cannot escape from the invasive nature of cyberbullying.

An effective solution is to have more secure passwords. Simple passwords make it easy for cybercriminals to steal personal information, so the best defense is to create passwords that are more complex. **To resolve the serious effects** of cyberbullying, strict age restrictions for social media are needed. Governments must force social media companies to deny access to minors so as to remove this tool from the hands of bullies. For instance, you have to be 13 to use social media platforms in the USA, but if that age limit were raised to 16, there would be significantly less bullying.

In conclusion, the ways that the internet has led to personal information being stolen and students being cyberbullied are by far the most significant problems it has created, and the most effective solutions are to use more complicated passwords and for minors not to be given access to social media.

Task 2- Sample 17

In some countries, many more people are choosing to live alone nowadays than in the past.

Do you think this is a positive or negative development?

There are countries where more people are deciding to live by themselves than they did in the past. This essay would argue that this is a positive development because **these people's actions are not restricted by their housemates**, and when people live alone, **it helps a country's economy**.

When people live alone, they do not need to accommodate others who are living with them. This can reduce the stress of having to resolve any conflict that may occur due to people having different ideas of how a house should be maintained, and it can help them to save time by not having to wait for others to **finish using appliances or equipment that they need to use**. For example, **it has recently been reported that** people who live on their own suffer far less anxiety related issues than those who share their living space.

As well as that, a country's economy will grow if more people are living alone. This is because these people are no longer sharing bills, and, **therefore**, more money is being spent. **Also**, to avoid loneliness, these people tend to get out of the house more often and engage in social activities with their friends and family, **which results in** more spending and aids economic development even further. For instance, in universities across America, students who stay in one-bedroom apartments rarely stay at home during the evenings, but this is not the case for those who live in shared accommodation.

In conclusion, the increasing trend of people living alone is beneficial as these individuals **have freedom from the stresses** of sharing accommodation with others, and it **creates more spending**, which is good for the economy.

Task 2- Sample 18

Wealthy countries should accept more refugees and provide them with basic assistance such as food and housing.

To what extent do you agree or disagree?

It is argued that rich nations ought to allow greater numbers of forced migrants past their borders and give them humanitarian relief. This essay totally agrees with this opinion because it is the morally correct thing to do, and it will also help their economies in the long run.

Many refugees will die or come to serious harm if they are not accepted by Western states because they are fleeing their homelands due to war and famine, and it is therefore morally imperative that they allow them in. That is to say that if they did not shelter and feed them, they would be responsible for many deaths and terrible suffering. For example, migrants from Syria are escaping a brutal war, and this is the reason why Germany and other European countries have decided to grant hundreds of thousands of them asylum.

Thousands of extra people coming into a country will also help boost the economy. This is because there will be more workers available, and they will, in turn, pay tax and also buy goods and services in that country. They may need extra financial support in the beginning, but this will be paid back many times over if they stay and work. For example, millions of Vietnamese people were forced to leave their homeland in the 1970s, and many of them have established thriving businesses in the USA, which pay billions of dollars in tax every year.

In conclusion, refugees should be accepted with open arms by countries in the Western Hemisphere because it is the morally right thing to do, and it will also benefit the host countries monetarily in the future.

Task 2- Sample 19

Governments give lots of support to artists, even though some people think it is a waste of money that could have been spent better elsewhere.

Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Many artists are well supported by their governments, but some feel that this is a misuse of taxpayers' money. Although **many arts venues would have to cease operating without such funding**, I feel that public healthcare is in more urgent need of the money.

On the one hand, it is difficult for many arts institutions to generate profit, so without some help from their government, many theatres and other such places may have to close. It is important that governments assist such institutions so that they can continue to provide entertainment to the public. For example, there are many open-air concerts in the summer months in the UK which would not exist without the financial backing of local councils. **However, I would argue that** if these places were popular enough, they would be able to generate their own income.

On the other hand, **public hospitals all over the world are under financial strain**. It would seem obvious that people's health is of more importance than people's entertainment, so this money should be given to hospitals **to upgrade equipment** and **shorten waiting lists**. For instance, Downshire Hospital in Ireland has blamed a lack of public funding for its shortage of nurses and available beds. **Therefore, I** feel that the money given to artists should be redirected into the healthcare system.

In conclusion, **although there would be** fewer venues dedicated to presenting the work of artists, **I maintain that** government funds should be put into hospitals **because people's** health is a more worthy cause.



Task 2- Sample 20

More and more people in developing countries are purchasing cars for the first time.

What **problems does this cause?**

What do you think are some possible **solutions?**

An increasing number of people from developing nations are making their first car purchases. **The principal problems** this causes are **pollution** and **traffic congestion**, and the most viable solutions are **electric engines** and **better public transport**.

One dilemma developing countries face when their citizens start to buy cars is increased pollution. **One of the primary causes** of air pollution is automobiles, and every additional car added to the road further exacerbates the situation. In addition, traffic jams are also becoming more common. **This is because** roads that were built for horses, carts and even bicycles are now clogged during peak times because of the growing number of personal vehicles. For example, there were never any traffic jams in Ho Chi Minh City 20 years ago, but with the ever increasing number of cars, it takes much longer to commute now.

The first solution to this problem is switching to electric engines. These types of engines are known to be far less harmful to the environment, and as more cars use these in favour of traditional combustion engines, air pollution will improve. Another solution is to build superior public transport systems. High quality public transport would counteract the issues currently seen by excessive car purchases as most people are already exasperated with the amount of time they spend in traffic and would sell their cars if there was a better alternative. For instance, in Japan, very few people own cars because of the incredible public transport system that is in place.

In conclusion, **the main problems associated** with the rise in the number of motor vehicles in developing countries are **the decrease in air quality** and **clogging of the roads**, but these can be addressed with **the use of electric cars** and by **providing modern public-transport**.

Task 2- Sample 21

Many teenagers have their own smartphones.

Does this situation have more advantages or more disadvantages?

Many adolescents own a smart device. This essay argues that despite the main advantage of this being they have the ability to stay in contact with their parents, I believe that there are more disadvantages as this creates a lack of face to face communication, which has many detrimental effects.

The biggest benefit of teenagers having mobile phones is the fact that their parents can call them and even check on their location. This is because smartphones have GPS, and many apps allow parents to accurately determine where their child is or simply message them to make sure they are safe. For example, messaging apps like Viber have a location setting so that parents can ask where their children are in a message and then check on Google Maps when their loved ones respond. However, the biggest damage mobile phones causes teenagers is a lack of physical contact.

Some believe that the drawback to teens having smartphones is that they will spend too much time on their phones, and this will reduce the amount of time they spend talking face to face. Face to face communication allows children to develop their social skills and grow as human beings, and they may become anti-social adults in the future if they are staring at a screen all day. For instance, it is very common to go into any coffee shop and see large groups of young people sitting around and not talking for several minutes because they are so engrossed in their smartphones. Therefore, this essay believes that smartphones, overall, have a detrimental effect on adolescents.

In conclusion, the primary value of teenagers having smartphones is the fact that they will be safer because their parents can communicate with them and locate them easily; however, I believe that a possible lack of social development is a major downside.

Task 2- Sample 22

Climate change is the biggest threat to life on our planet.

How accurate is this statement?

Are there any other big threats to mankind?

It is claimed that global warming is the chief threat to human civilization. This essay does not agree with this statement because people can find technological solutions to this problem. However, there is another graver threat, which is that of nuclear weapons as this cannot be so easily solved.

Some would argue that the increase in the planet's average temperature will lead to catastrophe on a global scale; however, the technology already exists to stem this threat. Solar power, combined with the use of electric vehicles, will remove the need for fossil-fueled power stations and transportation. The result will be a massive reduction in the release of greenhouse gases into the earth's atmosphere, which are the principal cause of global warming. For example, Tesla Motors produces excellent cars that produce zero CO₂, and its sister company, Solar City, allows people to produce their own electricity using innovative photovoltaic roof tiles and Powerwall battery packs.

A much larger danger is that of thermo-nuclear war. It would only take one blunder or the outbreak of a major war between nuclear states to wipe out every living thing on earth. This would be caused by the explosions themselves, and the ensuing nuclear winter which would wipe out all plant life and poison the air and oceans. For instance, the United States of America alone has enough nuclear warheads to wipe out every man, woman, and child on earth with its arsenal, and the Cuban Missile Crisis in the 1960s demonstrated how close it is possible to come to global nuclear war.

In conclusion, climate change is not the gravest peril the earth faces because we have the technological capability to solve it, and the threat from nuclear arms is much greater.